



Analysis & Deconstruction



TEAMFIGHT TACTICS



Release date: June 26, 2019 (PC) / March 19, 2020 (iOS & Android)

Genre: Auto-chess / Strategy

Platform: Windows, macOS / iOS / Android

Rating: PEGI 12

Players: 8

An auto-battler set in the world of Runeterra!

-  Constant game renewal through **seasonal updates**
-  Intuitive **gameplay**, while preserving the **competitive edge**
-  Your LoL champions available to everyone!

Manage and pit your **favorite champions** from every corner of **Runeterra** against each other! Assemble your dream team, place them **wisely** on your **board**, and defeat your opponents by being the **last one standing**!





Main Camera:

Fixed top-down $\frac{3}{4}$ camera

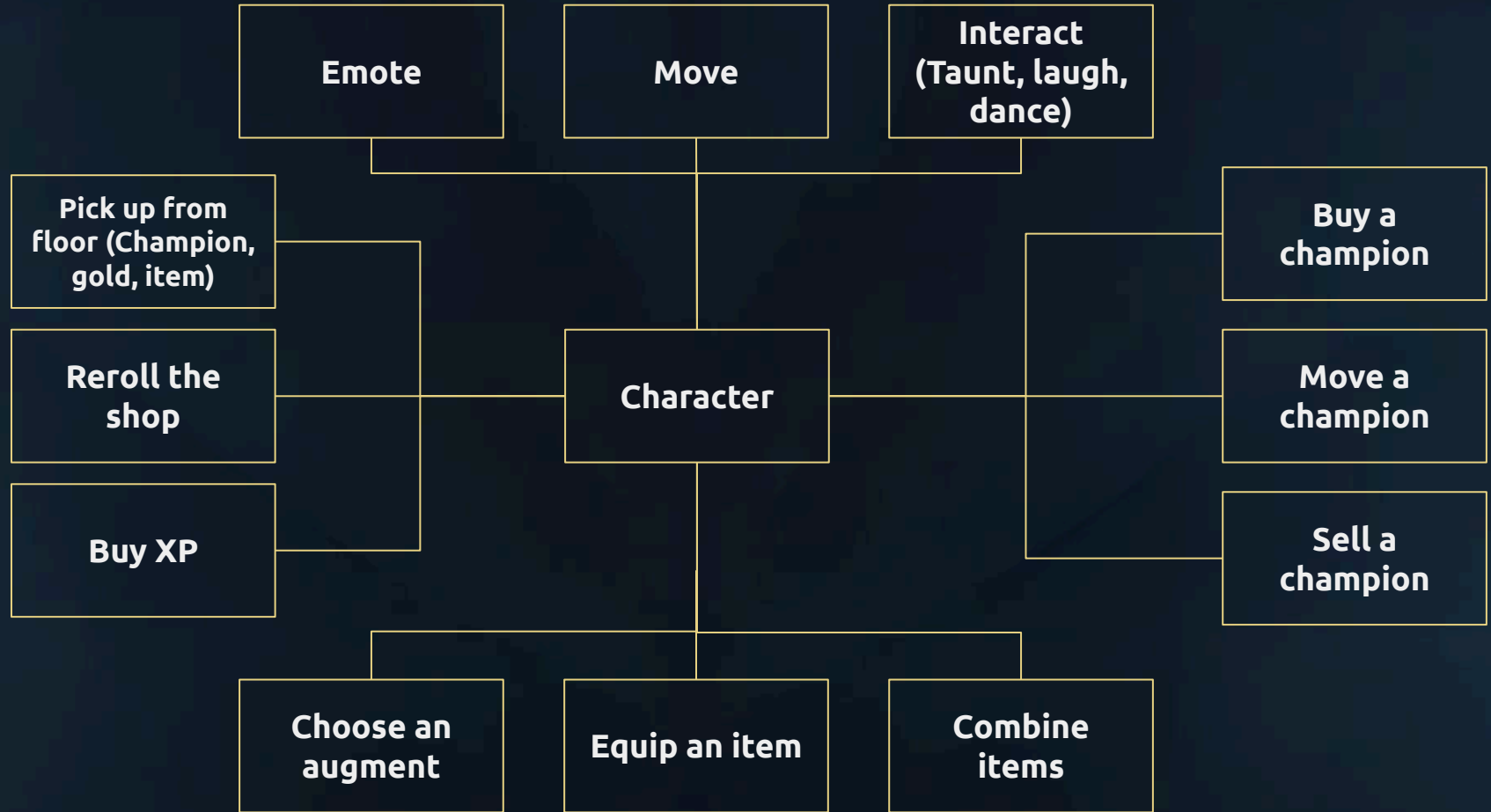


Contextual Camera:

Zoom to fit on terrain
transition

Camera pan on victory





3C - Controls



Move
Buy a champion
Interact (emote...)
Choose an augment
Buy a champion
Reroll the shop
Buy XP



Move a champion
Equip an item
Combine items



Core Loop

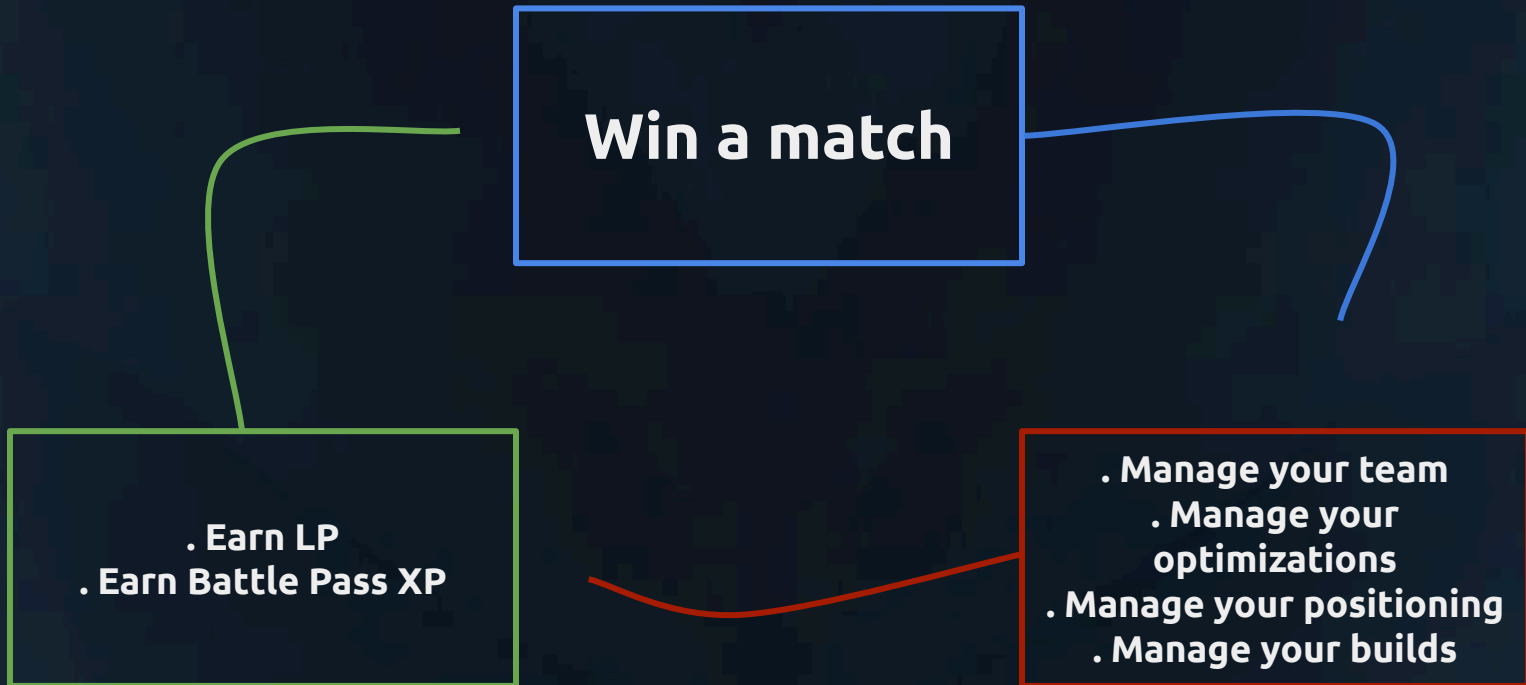


The TFT Core Loop involves no gameplay change - it is purely cosmetic.



Macro Loop





Place a champion on the board

- . Maximize the champion's utility on the board

- . Position your champion well
- . Think about possible combos based on positioning



Competition:

TFT remains a RIOT GAMES title, closely following the studio's standards. The game is **FREE TO PLAY** with all gameplay content available.

With deep design and a purely competitive focus (aside from temporary PVE modes), TFT fully embraces that.

The ranked ladder is therefore one of the only progression systems in TFT. The game relies entirely on social comparison - both skill-based and through potential conspicuous consumption.



Battle Pass:

TFT has only one XP system: the Battle Pass. The pass resets each season, goes up to level 40 (fixed rewards) but can be extended infinitely (reward loop).



The pass is not directly used as a social comparison tool, but when purchased, it grants exclusive rewards tied to level (skins, effects, currency), playing on conspicuous consumption.

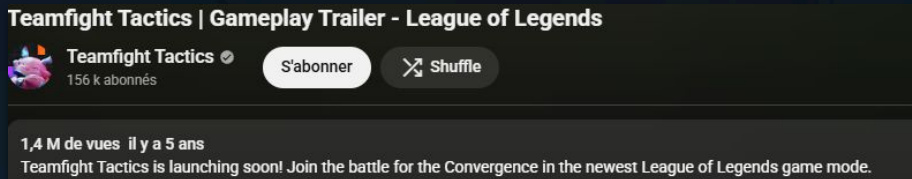
It also introduces the player to Gacha mechanics, which could push them toward spending.



The acquisition of **TFT Mobile** rests entirely on the **philosophy of its creators**, Riot:

TFT follows a formula already proven by competitors and applies **its usual standards**. The game is **100% free** in its gameplay (no **pay-to-win** mechanics, nothing to unlock via purchase) and only monetizes **cosmetic options**.

TFT was **already a hit on PC** with a solid player base, and as a Riot title using the League of Legends license, it naturally leverages this for acquisition to tap into **a player base already tied to the studio**.





Daily quests for the battle pass



Patch system: Game balance is reviewed every 15 days to refresh the experience and keep things balanced. These patches also refresh the shop. New skins are deployed with each patch, some temporary (to create FOMO).



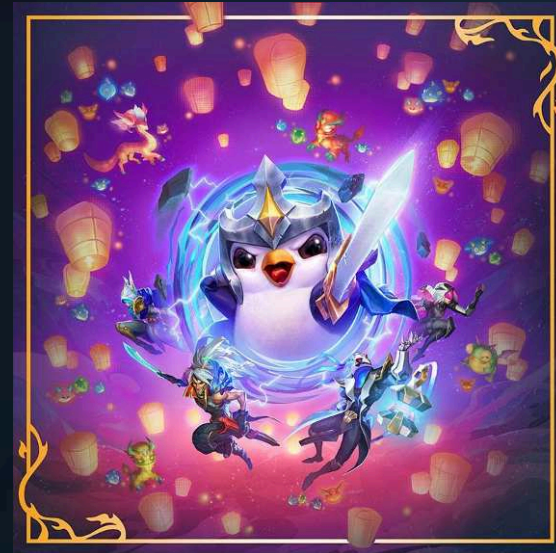
Season system: A complete gameplay overhaul between seasons. Each season has its own theme and a sort of USP.



Temporary game modes: TFT periodically deploys temporary game modes that change the gameplay.



Temporary events: TFT periodically deploys events (Viego's Black Mist, Arcane Season 1, Arcane Season 2)



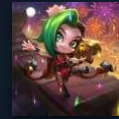
The **monetization** is purely cosmetic. **3 paid axes** cover it:



Battle Pass: When purchased, grants access to certain skins with effects. Also allows earning more hard currency.



Gacha: Purchase of hard currency "Treasure Tokens", spendable in the gacha. The gacha includes chances for skins, exclusive skins, hard currency, and effects.



Individual skins: Purchase individual skins at a fixed price in hard currency "Riot Points".



Team building: **Manage** your team, its positioning, and adapt against opponents.

Combos: TFT relies heavily on **synergies** between team composition, champion traits, items, positioning, and augments.

Luck management: TFT constantly keeps probabilities throughout its gameplay in all directions. The probabilities are **calculable** and are a core part of the **gameplay**.

DOTA Underlords

DOTA Underlords is, like TFT Mobile, a simple **port** of the live game to a mobile platform.

Derived from the **mode** of DOTA that gave birth to the AUTO CHESS genre, DOTA Underlords operates on **nearly the same mechanics** as TFT but in a more simplified form.



HearthStone Battlegrounds

Hearthstone Battlegrounds is further from TFT. It is **not an auto chess**, but was developed as a **fusion** of auto chess mechanics and its base game mechanics (CCG).

Interesting to analyze here: the TFT and HS Battlegrounds communities **frequently interact often**.





Pricing :

TFT is caught between several **business models**.

Previously only **gacha / individual skin purchases** (egg system similar to skin chests),

TFT **now opens up** to a **whale market**.

The old gacha has become "**premium**", only accessible for around **€150** for a unique skin.

[From 2021 to 2024, TFT reportedly generated \\$523M.](#)

Team building:

In TFT, team building is a **complex** and **evolving** process where the player must constantly adapt to units offered by the **shop**, to **items** collected, and to the **dynamics** of the **lobby**. **Precise grid positioning**, management of **the economy** and **champion levels** add **strategic depth**. The game is extremely **complete** and **flexible**, although late game relies heavily on **scouting** opposing players.





UNDERLORDS™

Pricing:

DOTA Underlords was a quick **response** to the community game mode of **DOTA**. The game was not a clear success: after peaking at **200k players**, in 2022 the game lives around **5k monthly players**.

Valve **discloses no** revenue figures for Underlords: [One week in Belarus in 2022 generated \\$30.](#)

The game does not offer **large bundles**, extremely rare skins, or aggressive purchases. The battle pass is **fairly low** (€4.99), and other cosmetics **are lightweight**.

Team building:

In **Dota Underlords**, team building revolves around the **alliances** that the **heroes** belong to. The **shop** and **items** are more **predictable**, with less **variance** than in TFT or Battlegrounds, and unit positioning is **nearly automatic**. This favors a more **measured** and **linear** team building approach, with **less** micro-management but also **less** flexibility.





Pricing:

Hearthstone is a card game where spending money is nearly **mandatory**. However in **Battlegrounds** the entirety of the gameplay is **available**. The only in-app purchases are **cosmetic**. Prices range from **€5** to **€25**. This is a game targeting **dolphins (mid-spenders)**.

Revenue figures for Battlegrounds are unavailable, however we have **estimates** for Hearthstone overall.

In 2022, Hearthstone reportedly generated \$61.5M, with the game declining year over year.

Team building:

In **Hearthstone Battlegrounds**, team **building** centers on **synergies** of unit types, with a simple **recruitment** system where all units **cost** the **same price**. The player must adjust their **choices** based on **options** of the **shop** and their **base** hero. Placement and unit management are largely **automated**. Risk-taking, adaptation, and strategy are **simplified**.



TFT Mobile technically has no **FTUE** or **tutorial phase**. The game only features **POPUPS** when launching a new account (shown here for the PC version, but equivalent on **Mobile**).

TFT therefore lets the player figure out the mechanics **chaotically? Yes and no.**

A new TFT account **cannot** play ranked matches. It is forced to play **3 normal PVP matches**. What the game doesn't tell you: those 3 normal matches are actually **PVE against bots** that are extremely **easy**.

The player is therefore eased in **over 3 matches**, able to test, understand the systems, and experiment without being heavily punished.



Base:

Each **TFT unit** has a rarity and **stats** that scale based on star count:

- HP, AD, Armor, AS, Crit%, Crit Dmg, Mana, AP, RM, Range

Units also belong to one or more "**family**" of champion, each **family** has a **unique passive** based on the number of champions of that family **active** on the board.

Here, this **Samira** belongs to the **Street Demon** and **A.M.P.** She is **rarity 5**, so the unit costs 5 gold. Her stats are fixed, scaling based on her star level.

To upgrade a unit to more stars, we need **3 units with the same star count**. 3 one-star Samiras give 1 two-star Samira. 3 two-star Samiras give 1 **three-star Samira**.

Samira

Attack Caster

Street Demon

A.M.P.

5

Ability	Stats
Key ★ / ★★ / ★★★	
Health ♥ 900/1620/2916	Mana 💧 20/100
Attack Damage 🔥 70/105/158	Ability Power ⚡ 100
Armor 🛡️ 40	Magic Resist 🛡️ 40
Attack Speed 🔪 0.8	Crit Chance 🔪 25%
Crit Damage 🔪 140%	Range 🏹 4



Shop and placement:

Each **TFT unit** can be placed on the board. The number of units active on the board **equals the level** of the player in the match (LVL 1 → 1 champion, LVL 2 → 2 champions...etc). Earning **XP** is done **for free** every round, but it can also be **purchased**.

The **shop** offers **champions** for purchase, with rarity matching our level. The higher our **level** is, the more the **shop** offers rare units.

The shop **refreshes** after each round **for free**, but can also be **rerolled** for gold.



Items & Carousel:

At the end of each round sequence, the player gets a **PVE round**. This **round** lets the player **drop units, gold** but most importantly **items** that can be **combined**. A basic item grants **raw stats**, a combined one grants an **addition** of stats plus a **passive** to the equipped champion.

After this phase, players enter a phase of **carousels**, random champions with random items are available. Players pick 1 champion (with 1 equipped item) based on their **reverse standing**, giving **last-place players an advantage**.



Augments:

Several times during the match, **simultaneously**, players get a choice of **3 augments** of the same **rarity**. These augments grant an **exclusive passive**. They can be **rerolled** once.

There are 3 augment **rarities**:
Silver, Gold, Prismatic

A match includes at **most** 3 augment selections.



How to become better:

A good TFT player plans, analyzes, and identifies their odds. A good player knows, based on percentages and opponent luck, the probability of getting a given champion or item at a given moment.

A good player knows the best champion families, the best positioning on the board, and the best items for each champion.

Overall, TFT is a game of mental analysis with very few micro aspects. It is a game that relies largely on macro play.



Correlation Chart



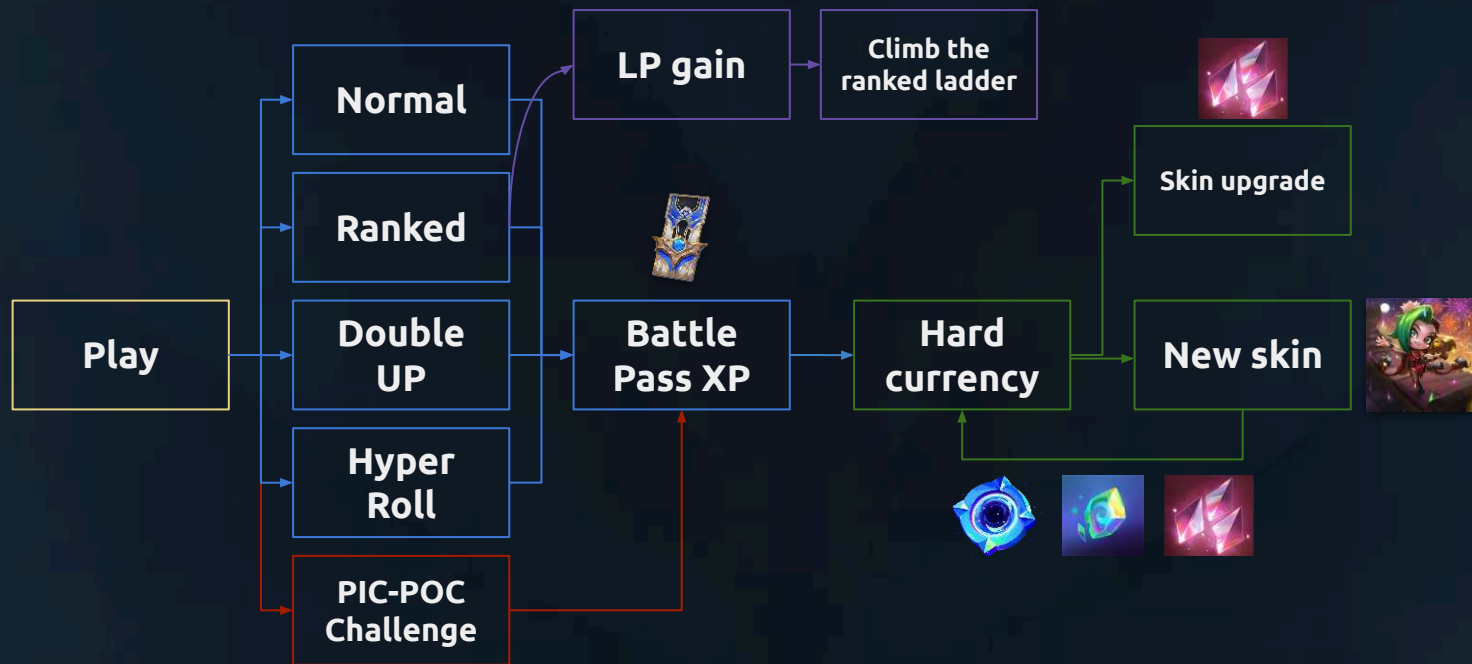
Completion

Farming

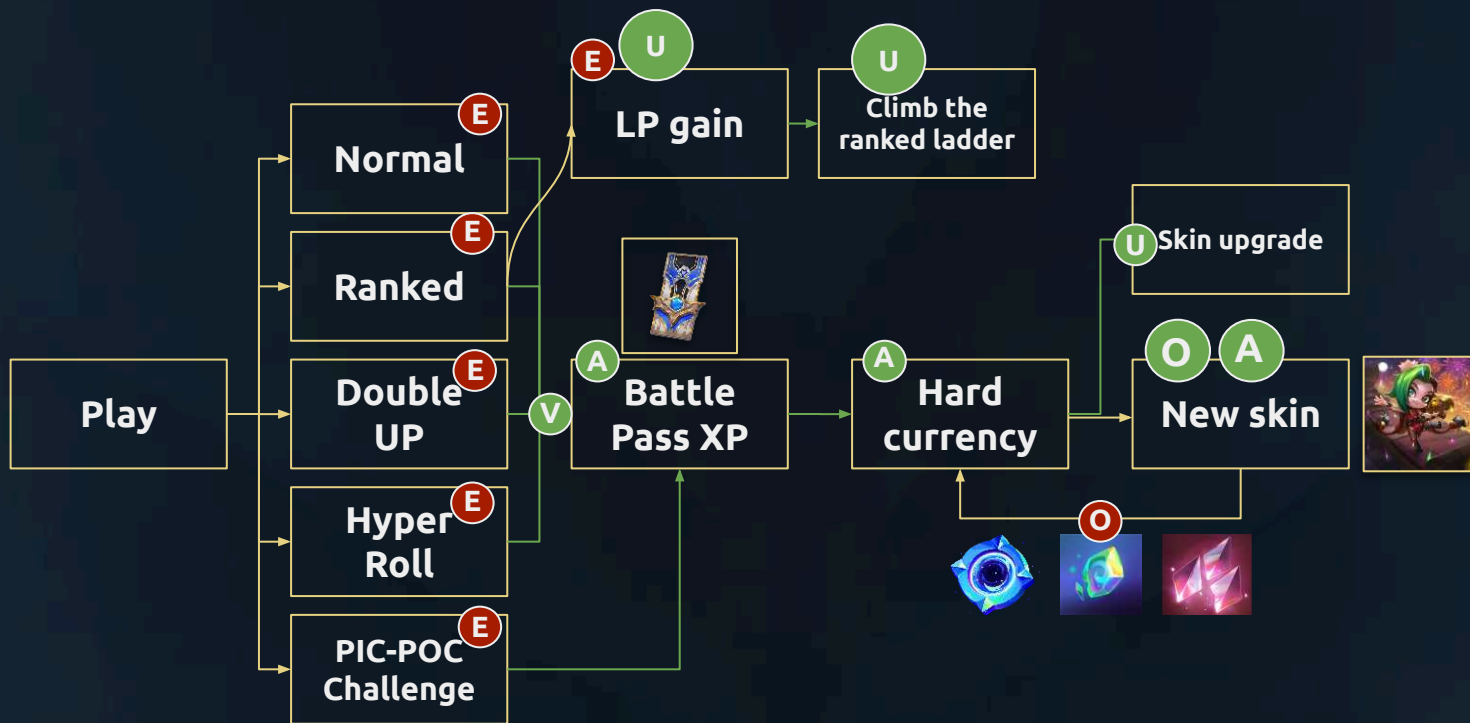
Collection

Social

Layer of Gameplay



Acquisition	Upgrade	Victory	Spending	Failure	Outcome	Farm
A	U	V	D	E	O O	F





**THANK YOU FOR
YOUR ATTENTION!**

Special thanks to TFT streamer and pro player "**Opesanec**" for their help

